Pain Management Options for Patients

Background: WHA now offers Rx options and Nitrous Oxide via the Pronox machine to our patients for anxiety and pain management for visits.

FYIs:

- Patients must pay a fee at check in or check out for their Nitrous Oxide assisted visit ($100 for Commercial insurance patients, $30 for Medicaid / Medicare patients and $100 for Self-Pay patients)
- If patients have Medicare as primary or secondary, it will still only be $30 (even if they have a Supplemental plan)
- If patient is requesting IOS for their visit and have not met with a WHA Provider about it before, we need to schedule an Est Office Visit first
- If patient is established with WHA and requesting an Rx for pain management, follow this workflow
- Nitrous Oxide is approved for OB patients who are 36+ weeks
- Nitrous is only approved for Clinician appts. A Clinician must be booked and present during Nitrous use

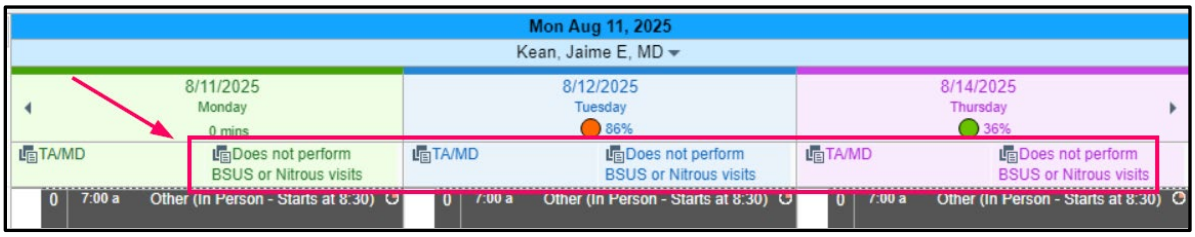
Quick links for:

- List of Providers that can be booked with Nitrous Oxide
- New Patient Workflow
- Est Patient Workflow – including Procedures
- Collecting Nitrous Oxide Fee
- Scheduling a visit with Nitrous Oxide
- What to do if patients are unsure which Pain Management option to choose

Which Providers can be currently booked with Nitrous Oxide?

- **Oregon City Clinic** - All Providers
- **Newberg Clinic** – All Providers
- **Tualatin Clinic** – All Providers - Except Dr. Fowler
- **West Hub** – All Providers - Except Sydney Larson
- **East Hub** – All Providers - Except Dr. Kean
- **NWP** – All Providers – Except Dr. Smrtka (and some US rooms – see Epic for note)

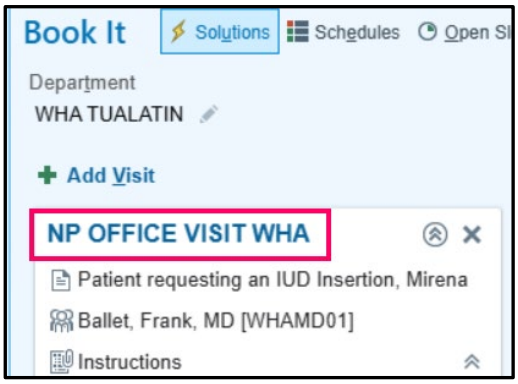
If the Provider has opted out, you should see a Template note like this one above their schedule in Epic:



New Patient Procedures–

- New patients that are requesting to be scheduled for a Procedure visit (whether they were referred by an outside Provider or not), need to be scheduled as a NP Office Visit.

  It needs to be communicated to the patient that the resources will be reserved for their visit, but it is up to their conversation had with the Provider to determine whether the Procedure will be done that day or not.

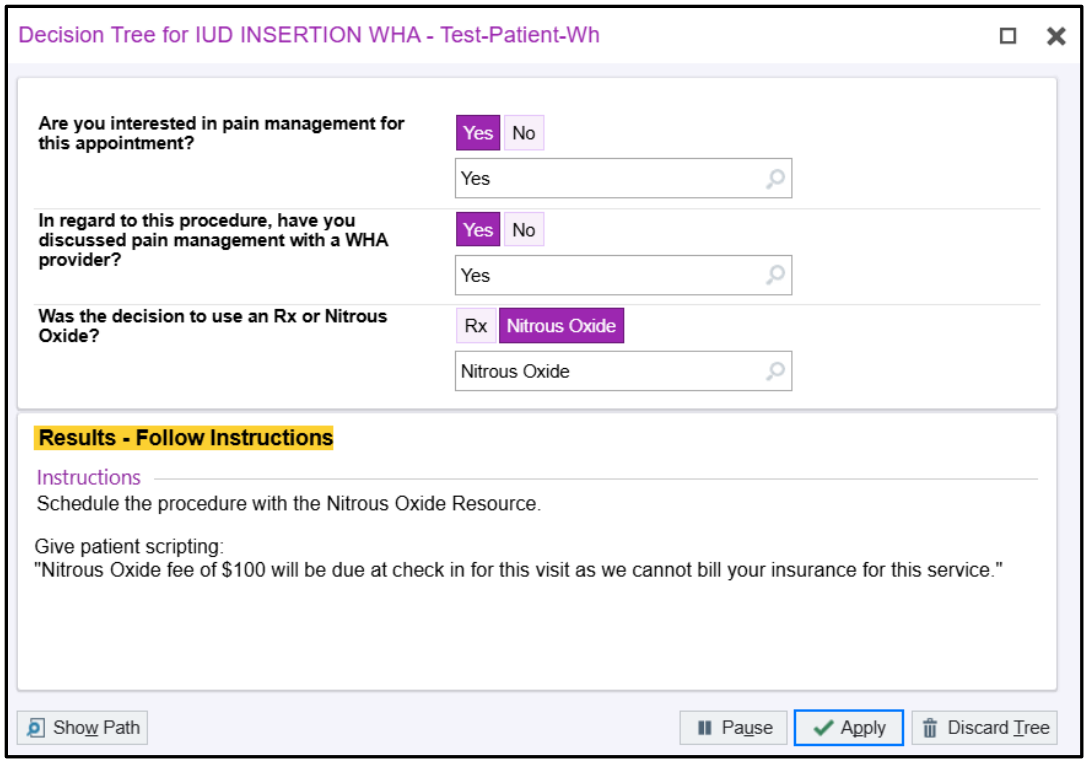


- This New Patient visit is to consult with the patient, while also having an opportunity to discuss pain management options if needed.

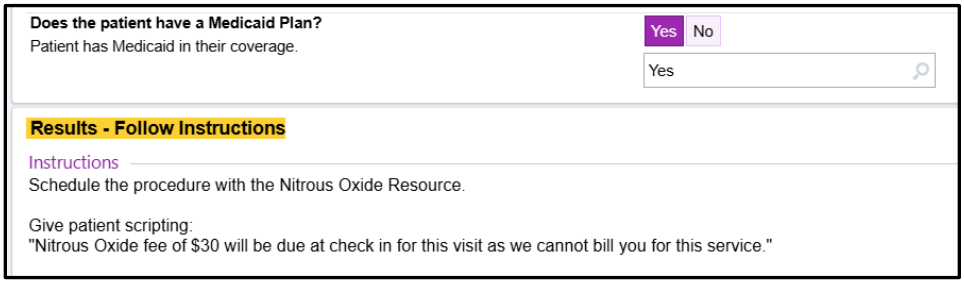
- If the patient mentions wanting pain management while you're still on the phone scheduling the initial New Patient Office Visit and add "Discuss pain management" to the Appt Notes.

Established Patients –

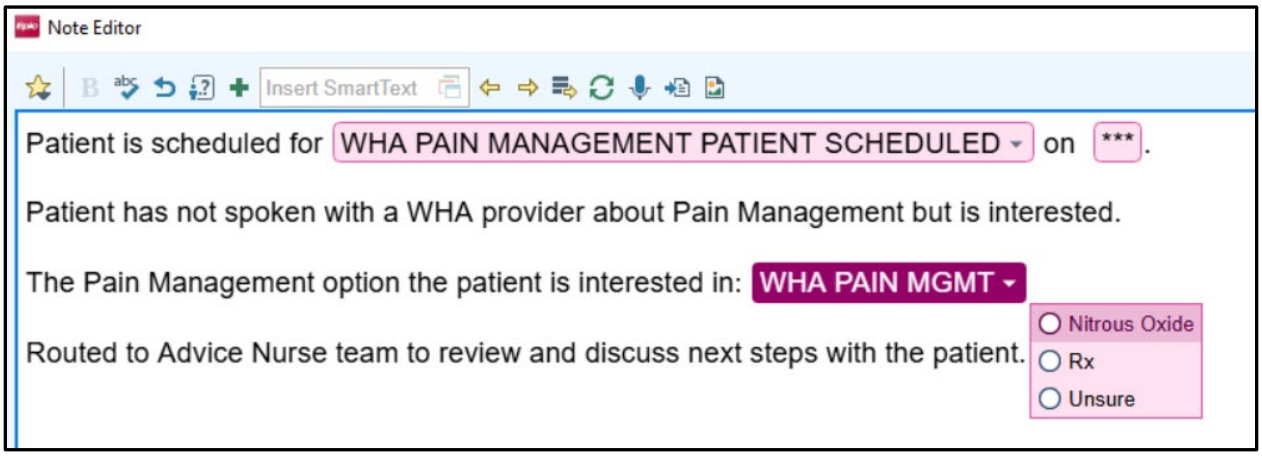
- Established patients that are being scheduled for a Procedure visit type will be prompted by a questionnaire asking the patient for more details about Pain Management choices and financial information. Nitrous is only approved for Clinician appts. A Clinician must be booked and present during Nitrous use.



- If the patient has a Medicaid plan, an additional question will appear:



- If the established patient is requesting an Rx for pain management for their scheduled visit and has not been consulted already, send a Telephone Encounter to the Advice Nurse Pool using the dot phrase .WHAPSPAINMANAGEMENTREVIEW



- If the patient does want Nitrous Oxide and **has been consulted** by a WHA provider already:
  1. Schedule the visit / Procedure **with** the Nitrous Oxide resource

  2. Tell the patient about the $100 fee (or $30 for Medicaid / Medicare insured patients) that will be due at the time of the visit

  3. Add "Requesting Nitrous Oxide" to Appt Notes

  4. Staff Message the Financial Coordinator Pool utilizing the dot phrase **.WHANITROUSDEPOSIT.** They will add a $100 prepay fee (or $30 for Medicaid / Medicare patients) to the visit.
     Pro Tip: Make a Staff Message template with the dot phrase above for better efficiency

- If the patient does want Nitrous Oxide and **has NOT been consulted** by a WHA provider:

  1. Schedule the visit / Procedure (without the Nitrous resource)

  2. Tell the patient about the $100 Nitrous Oxide fee (or $30 for Medicaid / Medicare insured patients) that will be due at the time of the visit if they do use Nitrous Oxide

  3. Add “Requesting Nitrous Oxide” to Appt Notes

  4. If patient has questions about Nitrous Oxide, cold transfer them to your site advice line to speak with a nurse. If the patient does not have questions about Nitrous Oxide, then no further action is needed

Collecting Nitrous Oxide Fee:

- Patients must pay a fee at check in or check out for their Nitrous Oxide assisted visit ($100 for Commercial insurance patients, $30 for Medicaid / Medicare patients and $100 for Self-Pay patients). If patients have Medicare as primary or secondary, it will still only be $30 (even if they have a Supplemental plan).

- The Patient Services team is able to collect a Nitrous Oxide fee without our Financial Team posting it prior. See the chapter titled Payment Categories / Payments – Adding a Prepay in the Check-In Manual for steps.

  This includes taking payments outside of Check-In. For example, when an MA walks the patient (who has already started the rooming process) back to the front desk to pay their Nitrous Oxide fee before starting their visit with the Provider.

- If a payment for a Nitrous Oxide fee is taken, Staff Message the Billing and Coding team to let them know so that they can apply the payment appropriately.

Collecting fee during Check-In:

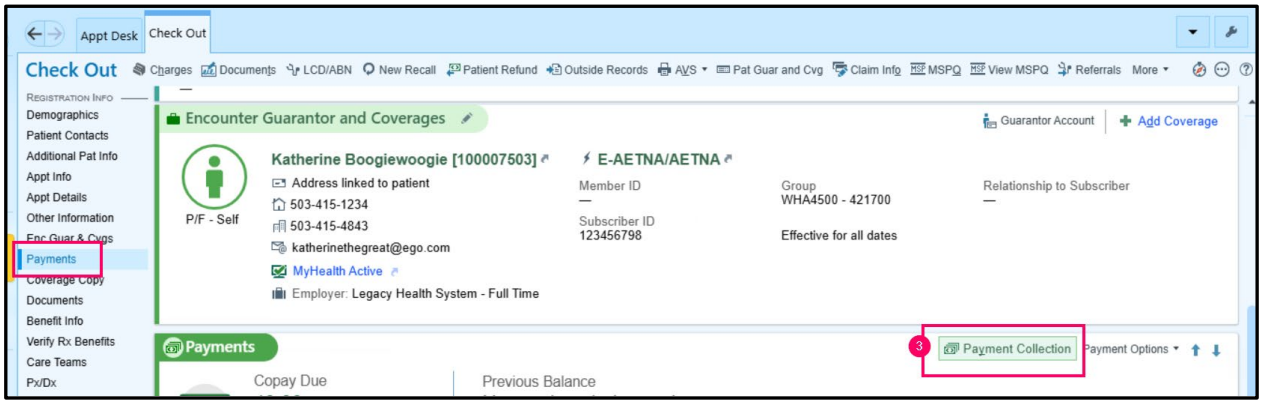
For patients paying at Check-In, the prepay fee could already be listed on the patient's account to apply the payment to. If you know the patient is getting Nitrous Oxide today and a prepayment is not listed, follow steps 2 – 4 under the Check-Out process below:

At **Check-Out**, patients may come back to the front desk after their visit with an orange laminate Nitrous Oxide card. When they do:

1. Collect the orange card 

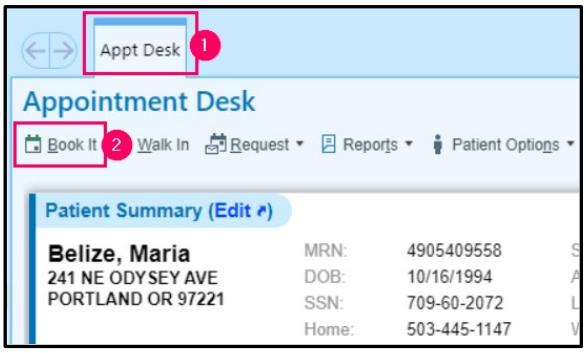
2. Verify what type of insurance the patient has in order to determine how much their fee will be ($100 for Commercial insurance patients, $30 for Medicaid / Medicare patients and $100 for Self-Pay patients)

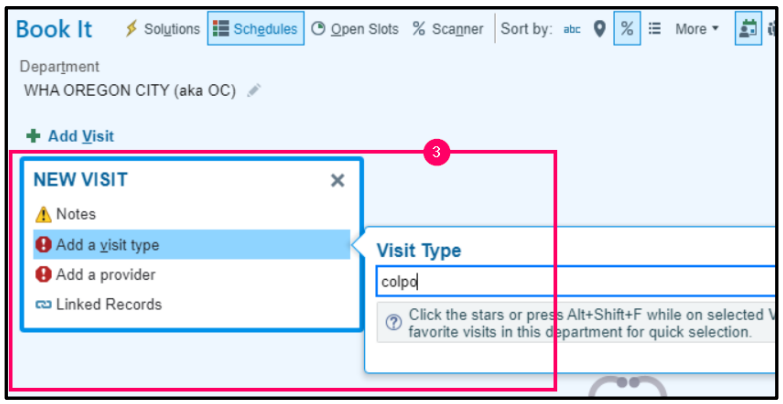
3. Use the Payment Collection tool in Epic or within the Payments section of the Check Out or Check In window, add a **PREPAY OTHER** with a comment that this is for same day Nitrous Oxide



4. Collect the appropriate fee amount from the patient
   - If you are collecting the $100 or $30 fee **during check-in**, use the Prepay listing of **OTHER AR**
   - If collecting the $100 or $30 fee **during check-out**, use the Prepay listing of **PREPAY OTHER**

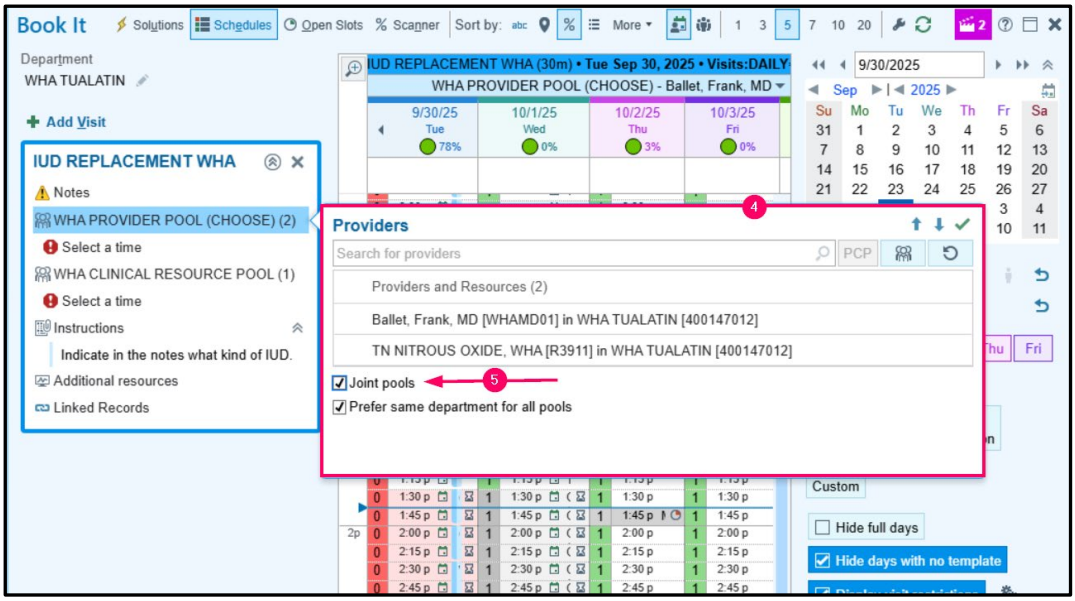
Scheduling a Visit with Nitrous Oxide:



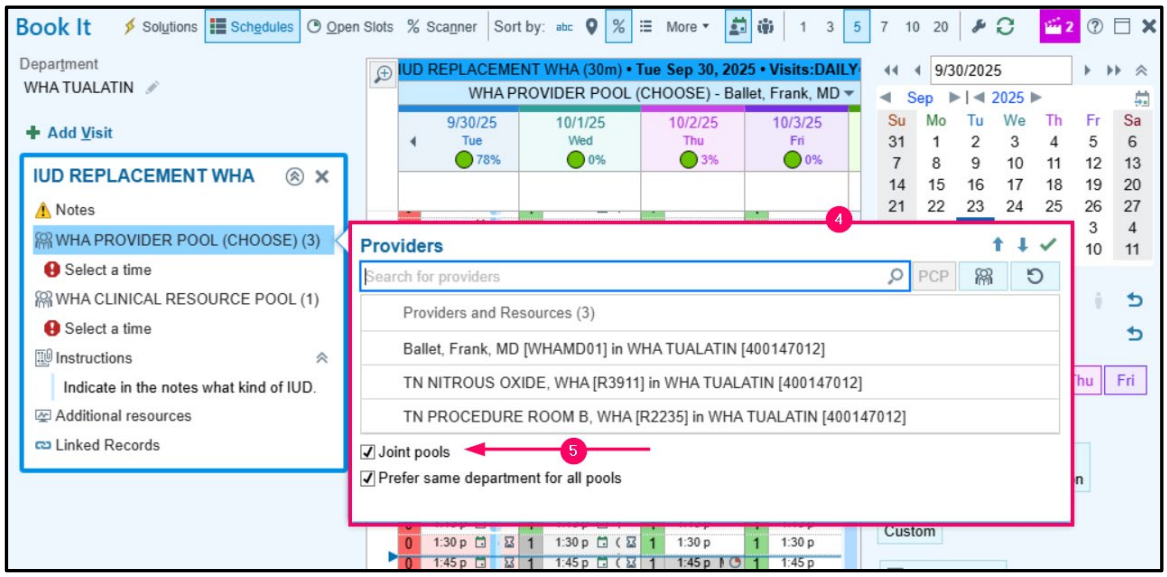


1. Go to patient's Appt Desk
2. Click Book It
3. Choose needed visit type (IUD / Repeat Pap / Colpo / Endo Biopsy / LEEP / Wellness etc.)

Example of scheduling a visit type with a Nitrous Oxide resource



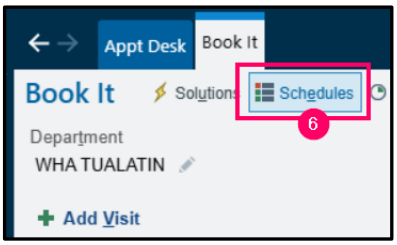
Example of scheduling a visit type w/ Nitrous Oxide **&** a Procedure Room

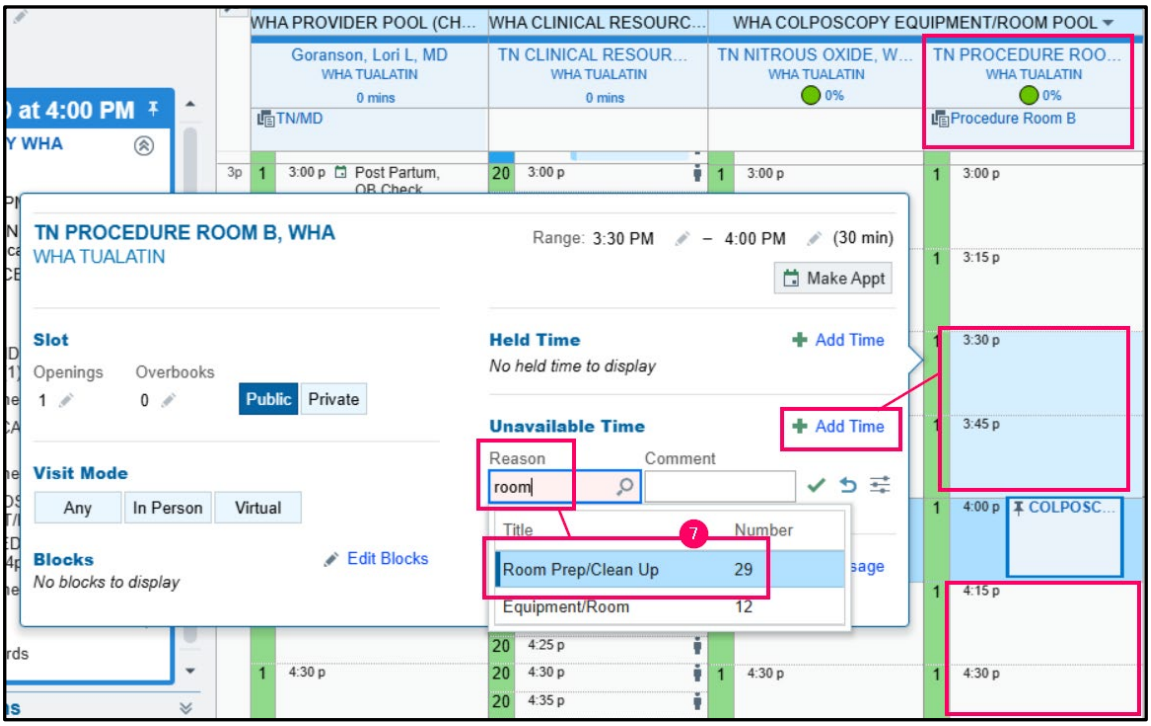


4. Fill out the Visit Card

- The Provider
- The Nitrous Oxide resource to reserve the Machine/device
- And if needed due to the visit type, add a designated procedure room for Colpo/LEEP etc

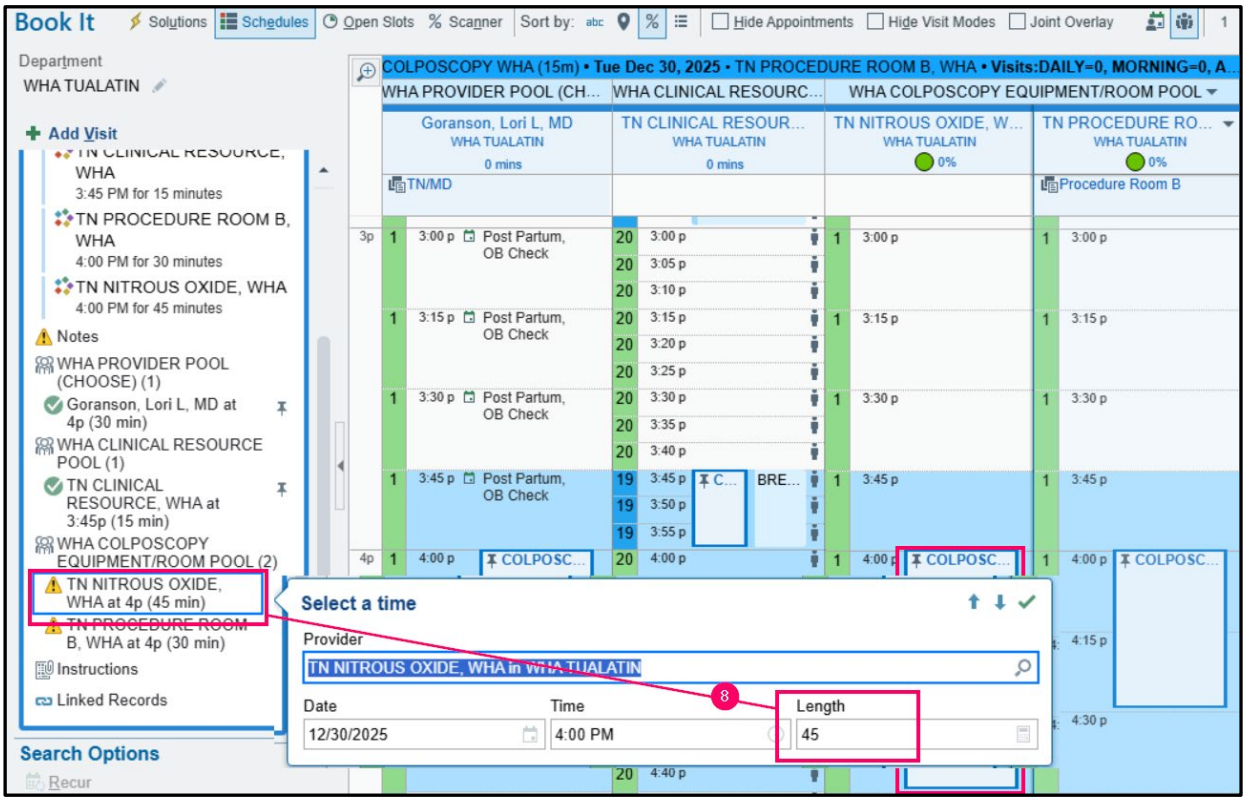
5. Click the **Joint Pools or Joint visit box** at the bottom left of the pop up





6. You can utilize the Solutions scheduling screen to find the next available slot for all 3 resources/provider, but schedule the visit within the Schedules view

7. If Procedure Room was booked for this visit: Within the Schedules view, after confirming the correct times have been chosen, block 15 - 20 minutes (depending on template length) before and after your visit on **the Procedure Room** schedule for Unavailable “Room Prep/Clean Up” time



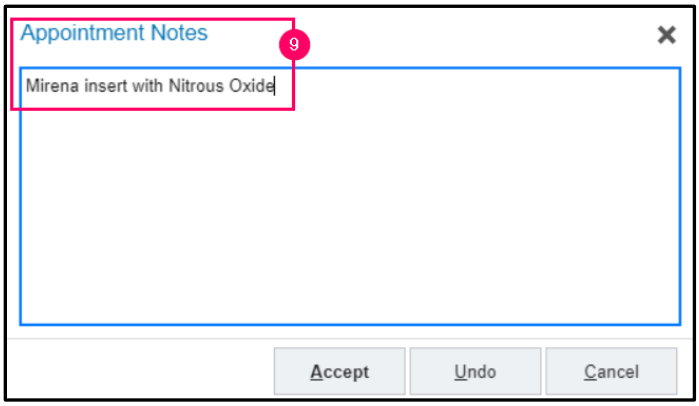
8. Within the visit card on the left, click on the **Nitrous Oxide resource** and change the length to 15 minutes longer than however long the Provider visit is (this way we don't have to add the room prep/unavailable time on the machine template)

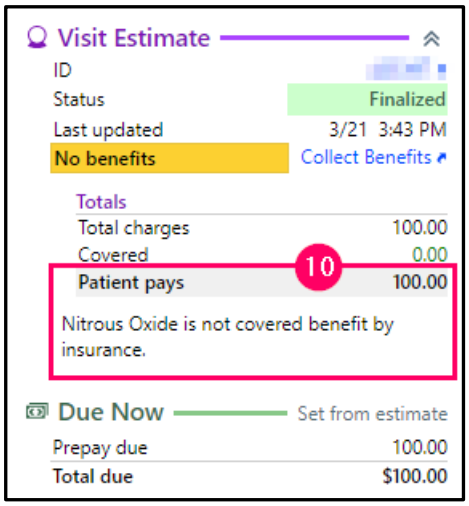
Example:

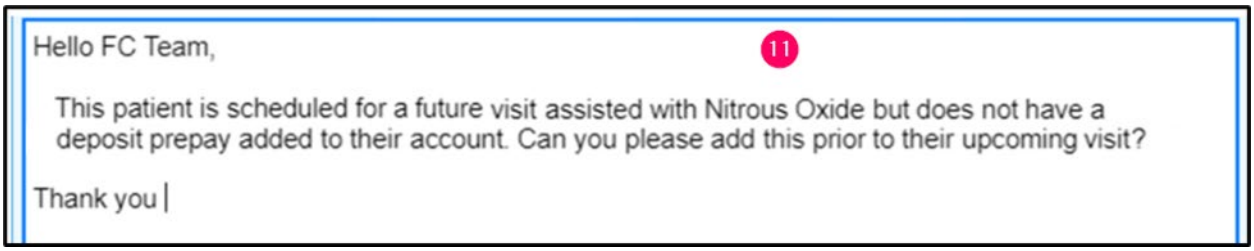
Visit length 30 mins = 45 mins Nitrous Oxide resource

Visit length 45 mins = 60 mins Nitrous Oxide resource

Note: Do this step whether or not you have booked a Procedure visit type







9. Once the visit has been scheduled, add Appt Notes for the visit including "with Nitrous Oxide" at the end (Example: Mirena insert with Nitrous Oxide)

10. Inform patient there will be a fee due at the time of check in for this visit

- $100 fee for Commercial plan insurance patients
- $30 fee for Medicare / Medicaid insurance patients

11. Send a Staff Message to the FC team utilizing the dot phrase .WHANITROUSDEPOSIT so they can add the fee amount to the patient's account

What if the patient is unsure on which type of Pain Management they are wanting?

- Do NOT send a Telephone Encounter to Advice
- Schedule appt as normal
- Let the patient know Pain Management options will be sent via MyHealth *(see Scripting below highlighted within the screenshot)*
- If they have questions now → warm transfer call to the Advice Nurse team
- If interested later → they can call back

